

ERFAN SHAHABI

NLP, LLM Researcher

✉ ErfanShahabi@outlook.com ☎ +98 912 640 40 96 📍 Tehran, Iran
🌐 erfanshahabi.github.io 🔗 LinkedIn 🐙 GitHub

Research Interests

Natural Language Processing, Large Language Models, Strategic Reasoning and Behavior of LLMs, Social Intelligence, Computational Social Science, Machine Behavior

Education

M.Sc in Information Technology Engineering, GPA: 4.00/4.00 Sep 2024 – Present
(17.76/20) Tehran, Iran

University of Tehran, School of ECE

- Supervisors: Dr. Azadeh Shakery, Dr. Yadollah Yaghoobzadeh
- Thesis: An Investigation and Enhancement of Strategic Behavior of Large Language Models in Social Context

B.Sc in Industrial Engineering, GPA: 4.00/4.00 (18.07/20) Sep 2019 – Aug 2023
Islamic Azad University, Science and Research Branch Tehran, Iran

- Supervisor: Dr. Abbas Saghaei
- Thesis: Used Car Price Prediction Using Machine Learning Methods

Publications

- **ProDAKD: A Profile-based Dialogue Agents Knowledge Distillation Approach for User Simulation in Conversational Recommender Systems**
Under Review at *ECIR 2026 Main Conference* 
E Shahabi*, A Roshandel*, M Sadeghi, V Rahimzadeh, A Shakery (*equal contribution)

Professional Experiences

Researcher Sep 2024 – Present
Intelligent Information Systems Lab ECE @ University of Tehran

- Supervisors: Dr. Azadeh Shakery, Dr. Yadollah Yaghoobzadeh
- Research Area: Strategic Behavior and Social Reasoning of LLMs

AI Engineer Feb 2026 – Present
Mofid Securities Tehran, Iran

- Developing AI-powered financial tools leveraging LLMs and information retrieval techniques

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Natural Language Processing (Graduate) Sep 2025 – Present
Course Website · Instructor: Dr. Hesham Faili ECE @ University of Tehran

- Designed TravelBot assignment: a conversational travel assistant using ReAct architecture and LangGraph for flight search, hotel booking, and trip planning
- Implemented RAG pipeline for retrieving destination information and generating personalized travel recommendations
- Led workshops mentoring students on LangChain and LangGraph frameworks for building agent-based systems

Teaching Assistant, Intelligent Information Retrieval (Graduate) Sep 2025 – Present
Course Website · Instructor: Dr. Azadeh Shakery ECE @ University of Tehran

- Designed assignments on conversational search, RAG systems, and multi-agent architectures
- Conducted workshops on probability theory and machine learning foundations for information retrieval
- Led technical workshops on LLMs in IR, covering LangChain, LangGraph, and ReAct patterns
- Guided students in implementing practical retrieval systems using state-of-the-art language models

Teaching Assistant, Advanced Data Mining (Graduate)

Instructor: *Dr. Azadeh Shakery*

Feb 2026 – Present

ECE @ University of Tehran

Teaching Assistant, Natural Language Processing (Graduate)

Instructor: *Dr. Yadollah Yaghoobzadeh*

Feb 2026 – Present

ECE @ University of Tehran

Selected Projects

- Fine-Tuning LLaMA-3.2 using ORPO and DPO for Human-Preference-Based Alignment [🔗](#)
- Quantization-Aware Reasoning and Text-to-SQL Agent Design using ReAct and LangGraph [🔗](#)
- ChatFood: Building a ReAct-based Conversational Food chatbot with LangGraph and Gemini [🔗](#)
- Conversational Search with RAG: Dataset Construction and Multifaceted Evaluation [🔗](#)
- Developing a RAG pipeline for oil and gas drilling chatbot for Binvest Co. [🔗](#)
- Deep Learning for Sequence Labeling and Text Summarization with RNNs and Attention [🔗](#)
- Sentiment Classification of IMDB Reviews using Text Preprocessing and Classical IR Techniques [🔗](#)
- Relevance Classification using BERT for Query-Document Pairs in IR Tasks [🔗](#)
- Semantic Clustering of StackOverflow Questions using Sentence Embeddings [🔗](#)
- Forecasting Community Dynamics in Social Graphs using Multi-Task GNNs [🔗](#)

Technical Skills

- **Soft Skills:** Teamwork, Meeting Tight Deadlines
- **Programming Languages:** Python
- **Large Language Models:** Hugging Face, LangChain, LangGraph, LangFuse, Unsloth, PEFT, Datasets, TRL
- **Databases:** SQL, LanceDB
- **Machine Learning:** PyTorch, Scikit-Learn, Evaluate, TensorFlow
- **Retrieval:** Sentence Transformers, Lexical Retrieval, Semantic Retrieval, BM25

Honors and Awards

- Ranked 14 in Nationwide Graduate Level University Entrance Test of Information Technology Engineering

Languages

- **Persian:** Native
- **English:** Fluent